

Moroccan Riad Café

Clay pots. Saffron smoke. Mint tea poured from height.

40	\$46	24%	\$57,292
SEATS	AVG SPEND	FOOD COST	EST. MONTHLY NET

// WHAT A MICHELIN-TRAINED CHEF SEES IN MOROCCAN COOKING

Moroccan spice work is the most complex in this collection. Ras el hanout — the name means 'top of the shop,' the best the spice merchant has — contains up to 30 individual spices, balanced against each other in proportions that vary by region, by family, by cook. The commercial version is a shortcut. Making it properly means toasting whole spices individually, grinding them separately, and combining them in a sequence that prevents the volatile aromatics of one spice from overwhelming another. Chermoula, harissa, preserved lemon: each one a complete flavour system in itself. The tagine is not a stew. It is a steam environment — the conical lid returns condensed moisture to the ingredients, basting them continuously for 3–4 hours. The result cannot be replicated in a standard pot.

// WHAT THIS GUIDE DOES

The mint tea ceremony at \$6.99 with a food cost of \$0.45 is the highest-margin item in this collection. It is also the one that drives dessert covers to near 100%. The riad café format photographs itself. The terracotta, the hand-painted tiles, the tagine arriving at the table: every service is content.

This guide builds the operation. Instagram builds the audience.

Entrées

Harira — Moroccan Tomato, Lentil & Lamb Soup

SERVICE: 5 min | FC: 18% | BATCH COOK | ALLERGENS: Gluten, May contain traces of nuts

- 1 Prepare lamb shoulder, tomatoes, lentils, chickpeas, onion, celery, parsley and coriander. Season with **ras el hanout**, turmeric, cinnamon, saffron.
- 2 Sweat onion and celery in olive oil until soft. Add lamb, brown evenly. Add spices and stir for 1 min.
- 3 Add tomatoes, lentils, chickpeas, stock. Simmer **90 min** until thick. Finish with lemon juice, fresh coriander, parsley.
- 4 Batch hold at **75°C+**. Serve with lemon wedge and crusty bread.

✂ Chef's note: The tdouira — a flour-water slurry — is added at the end for body. Don't skip it. It's what makes harira harira.

Briouats au Poulet — Chicken & Almond Pastilla Triangles

SERVICE: 6 min | FC: 20% | ALLERGENS: Gluten, Eggs, Nuts

- 1 Shred braised chicken. Mix with toasted almonds, egg, onion, parsley, cinnamon, ginger, saffron, icing sugar.
- 2 Cut warka (or filo) into strips. Place filling at base, fold into triangles, seal with egg wash.
- 3 Deep-fry at **180°C** for 3–4 min until golden. Drain. Dust with icing sugar and cinnamon.

✂ Chef's note: The sweet-savoury balance is intentional. Don't be tempted to reduce the sugar — it's architecturally correct.

Zaalouk — Smoky Aubergine Salad

SERVICE: 3 min | FC: 14% | BATCH COOK | VEGAN

- 1 Char aubergines directly over flame or under grill until completely collapsed and smoky. Peel, drain, roughly chop.
- 2 Cook with tomatoes, garlic, olive oil, cumin, paprika, preserved lemon until dry. Mash roughly — texture should be chunky, not smooth.
- 3 Finish with fresh coriander, lemon juice. Serve at room temp with warm bread.

Moroccan Carrot Salad with Cumin & Preserved Lemon

SERVICE: 3 min | FC: 12% | BATCH COOK | VEGAN

- 1 Steam or boil carrots until just tender. Drain, cool slightly.
- 2 Dress with olive oil, cumin, paprika, harissa, preserved lemon rind (finely chopped), honey, lemon juice.
- 3 Top with fresh coriander, black olives. Batch and hold chilled. Bring to room temp before service.

Entrées (continued)

Msemen — Flaky Moroccan Flatbread

SERVICE: 8 min | FC: 16%

- 1 Mix semolina, flour, salt, yeast, warm water into smooth dough. Rest 30 min.
- 2 Divide into balls. Stretch thin on oiled surface, fold into square layers. Rest again 10 min.
- 3 Cook on dry griddle medium-high 3–4 min per side until golden with charred patches.
- 4 Serve immediately with amlou (argan oil, almonds, honey) or alongside tagines and salads.

✂ Chef's note: The lamination is what creates the flaky layers. Oil your hands, not the bread — each fold traps air.

Kefta Cigares — Lamb Mince Rolls

SERVICE: 6 min | FC: 22%

- 1 Combine lamb mince, onion (grated), parsley, cumin, paprika, cinnamon, cayenne, salt. Mix thoroughly.
- 2 Roll into cigar shapes on warka or filo strips. Seal with egg wash. Chill until service.
- 3 Deep fry at 180°C for 4 min until dark golden. Drain on paper. Serve with harissa yoghurt.

Signature Mains

Lamb Tagine with Preserved Lemon & Olives SIGNATURE

SERVICE: 5 min | BATCH: 2.5hr | FC: 24% | BATCH COOK

- 1 Marinate bone-in lamb in chermoula (coriander, parsley, garlic, cumin, paprika, olive oil, lemon) overnight.
- 2 Layer onion, saffron water, ginger, turmeric in tagine base. Add lamb. Seal lid.
- 3 Cook at 160°C for 2.5 hours. Add preserved lemon quarters and green olives in final 30 min.
- 4 Serve in tagine with garnish of fresh coriander. Accompany with msemen or couscous.

✂ Chef's note: The tagine has been in the clay pot since 10am. You can't rush a tagine. That's why it tastes like it does.

24% 2.5hr 5 min

FOOD COSTBATCH TIMESERVICE TIME

Bastilla au Poulet — Moroccan Chicken & Almond Pie SIGNATURE

SERVICE: 8 min | FC: 24% | ALLERGENS: Gluten, Eggs, Nuts, Chicken

- 1 Braise chicken thighs with saffron, ginger, cinnamon, onion until very tender. Shred. Reserve braising liquid and reduce.

- 2 Assemble: egg gently in reduced braising liquid until just set. Combine with shredded chicken

- 2 Scramble eggs gently in reduced braising liquid until just set. Combine with shredded chicken.
- 3 Toast almonds, grind coarsely with cinnamon and icing sugar. Layer warka sheets with butter, chicken mixture, almond layer, seal.
- 4 Bake at **200°C** for 20 min until crisp and deep golden. Dust generously with icing sugar and cinnamon cross.

✂ Chef's note: The bastilla is our signature — chicken, almonds, eggs, cinnamon, icing sugar on top. It's sweet and savoury in the same bite. Made fresh this morning. 8 minutes.

Mains (continued)

Chicken Tagine with Apricot & Almond

SERVICE: 5 min | BATCH: 2hr | FC: 22%

- 1 Brown chicken pieces in olive oil. Remove. Sweat onion with ginger, turmeric, cinnamon, saffron.
- 2 Return chicken. Add dried apricots, honey, chicken stock. Cover and braise **2hr at 160°C**.
- 3 Top with toasted flaked almonds, fresh coriander before service.

Beef Kefta Tagine — Meatballs, Egg & Tomato

SERVICE: 15 min | FC: 23%

- 1 Roll beef mince (seasoned with cumin, paprika, coriander, mint, parsley, salt) into walnut-sized balls.
- 2 Build tomato sauce in tagine: onion, garlic, tomatoes, cumin, paprika, chilli, olive oil. Simmer 15 min.
- 3 Add kefta balls to sauce, cover and cook 10 min. Crack eggs on top, cover and cook **4 min** to set whites.
- 4 Serve in tagine, garnish with fresh coriander and drizzle of argan oil.

Couscous Royale — Lamb, Chicken, Merguez & Seven Vegetables

FRI-SUN SPECIAL | FC: 28% | ALLERGENS: Gluten, Meat

- 1 Prepare broth with lamb, chicken, merguez, onion, tomatoes, spices. Simmer **1.5hr**. Add vegetables in stages by density.
- 2 Steam couscous three times in couscoussier with butter between each steam for maximum fluffiness.
- 3 Mount couscous as dome on large platter. Arrange meats and vegetables. Pour ladle of broth over. Serve harissa separately.

✂ Service note: Friday and Saturday we do Couscous Royale — lamb, chicken, merguez,

seven vegetables. Different dish entirely. Worth coming back for.

Chermoula Grilled Prawns

SERVICE: 10 min | FC: 24% | ALLERGENS: Shellfish

- 1 Marinate king prawns in chermoula (coriander, parsley, garlic, cumin, paprika, preserved lemon, olive oil, lemon) min 30 min.
- 2 Grill on charcoal or griddle at **high heat** 2–3 min per side until charred and cooked through.
- 3 Serve on warm platter with extra chermoula, lemon wedges and warm msemen.

Mechoui — Slow-Roasted Lamb Shoulder

WEEKEND ONLY | 6hr OVEN | FC: 28%

- 1 Rub whole lamb shoulder with smen (aged butter), cumin, sea salt, coriander seeds. Work into all crevices.
- 2 Roast in sealed clay vessel or covered roasting pan at **150°C for 6hr**. Uncover for final 30 min to colour skin.
- 3 Rest **20 min**. Serve on communal platter. Guests pull meat with fingers, Moroccan style. Accompanies with cumin salt and bread.

Mains (final)

Rfissa — Shredded Chicken on Msemen with Fenugreek Broth

SERVICE: 8 min | BATCH COOK | FC: 21%

- 1 Braise chicken with fenugreek seeds, lentils, saffron, ginger, onion in rich broth. Shred chicken.
- 2 Tear msemen into rough pieces, layer in bowl base.
- 3 Layer shredded chicken over msemen. Ladle hot fenugreek-saffron broth over everything. Garnish with lentils and fresh coriander.

✂ Chef's note: Rfissa is celebratory home cooking — served after childbirth in Moroccan tradition. It carries cultural weight. Explain that to the table.

Lamb Mrouzia — Honey, Raisin & Ras el Hanout Tagine

SERVICE: 5 min | BATCH: 3hr | FC: 26%

- 1 Brown lamb chunks. Add ras el hanout, cinnamon, ginger, saffron, onion. Cover with water, braise **2hr at 160°C**.

- 2 Add honey, raisins, toasted almonds in final hour. Sauce should be thick, glossy, deeply caramelised.
- 3 Serve garnished with sesame seeds and extra almonds. The sweetness is a deliberate Andalusian-Moroccan flavour legacy.

Vegetarian Tagine — Root Vegetable, Chickpea & Preserved Lemon

SERVICE: 5 min | VEGAN | FC: 15%

- 1 Layer carrot, potato, turnip, butternut squash, courgette, chickpeas in tagine. Season with ras el hanout, cumin, turmeric, cinnamon.
- 2 Add preserved lemon, olive oil, water. Seal and cook at 170°C for 1.5hr.
- 3 Top with fresh coriander, green olives. Serve in tagine with couscous or msemen.

Desserts

Chebakia — Honey & Sesame Fried Pastry

SERVICE: 3 min | FC: 14% | ALLERGENS: Gluten, Sesame, Nuts

- 1 Mix flour, sesame seeds, anise, cinnamon, saffron, rose water, orange blossom water, vinegar, yeast, oil, eggs into dough.
- 2 Roll thin, cut into strips, fold into flower shape. Deep fry at 175°C until golden.
- 3 Immediately dip in warm honey infused with orange blossom water. Roll in sesame seeds. Allow to set.

✂ Service note: The Moroccan tradition is — you don't refuse tea. And the chebakia with the honey and sesame makes the second glass of tea mandatory. That's just how it works.

Kaab el Ghazal — Gazelle Horn Almond Pastries

SERVICE: 2 min | FC: 15% | ALLERGENS: Gluten, Nuts

- 1 Mix ground almonds with icing sugar, orange blossom water, butter, cinnamon. Roll into thin finger shapes.
- 2 Wrap in thin pastry dough, shape into crescent (gazelle horn). Bake at 180°C for 12 min — pale gold only, no browning.
- 3 Cool completely. Dust lightly with icing sugar. Serve with mint tea ceremony.

Desserts (continued)

Orange & Cinnamon Salad

SERVICE: 3 min | FC: 11% | VEGAN | GF

- 1 Peel and slice navel oranges into rounds. Arrange on chilled plate.
- 2 Dust generously with ground cinnamon. Drizzle orange blossom water and a little honey.
- 3 Garnish with fresh mint leaves and a few pomegranate seeds for colour.

➤ Chef's note: Deceptively simple. The orange blossom water elevates this from fruit plate to Moroccan classic. Do not skip it.

Seffa — Sweet Couscous with Raisins & Almonds

SERVICE: 4 min | FC: 17%

- 1 Steam fine couscous with butter. Fluff and sweeten with icing sugar and cinnamon.
- 2 Plump raisins in rose water and orange blossom water for 10 min. Toast flaked almonds.
- 3 Mount couscous as dome. Decorate with alternating rings of raisins and almonds. Dust with icing sugar and cinnamon. Serve warm.

Drinks

Moroccan Mint Tea — Atay

\$6.99 · 3 glasses · FC: \$0.45

Gunpowder green tea, fresh spearmint, sugar. Poured from height. Three rounds, each sweeter than the last.

Jus d'Avocat — Avocado Juice

\$8.99

Blended avocado, milk, honey, orange blossom water. Thick, creamy, cold.

Rose Water Lemonade

\$6.99

Fresh lemon, rose water, sugar syrup, still water. House signature non-alcoholic.

Iced Moroccan Coffee

\$6.99

Double espresso, cardamom, cold milk, ice. The spice distinguishes it.

Casablanca Beer

\$8.99

Moroccan pale lager. Light, clean, cold. The only beer on the menu.

Sidi Ali Mineral Water

\$4.99

Moroccan still mineral water. Authentic detail that guests notice.

Almond Milkshake — Lben Louz

\$7.99

Ground almonds, milk, honey, ice, rose water. Rich and sweet.

Fresh Pomegranate Juice

\$7.99

Pressed to order. Deep red, tart, seasonal. Pairs beautifully with bastilla.

✂ Drinks strategy: Lead with mint tea at welcome — \$0.45 cost, \$6.99 revenue, drives dessert uptake. The highest-margin item in the house. It is also a cultural ritual. Treat it as one.

Service Scripts

Memorise these. They are not suggestions — they are the revenue conversion layer of the operation.

01 — WELCOME & ATAY MINT TEA UPSELL

"Welcome to Moroccan Riad Café. Before we go through the menu — can I start you with our mint tea? The tea is served Moroccan style — poured from height, three glasses, each one sweeter than the last. \$6.99 for three glasses. Worth it."

02 — TAGINE EXPLANATION + COOK TIME

"The lamb tagine has been in the clay pot since 10am. You can't rush a tagine. That's why it tastes like it does. It comes to the table in the tagine — the lid comes off at the table. 5 minutes from now."

03 — BASTILLA PRE-SELL

"The bastilla is our signature — chicken, almonds, eggs, cinnamon, icing sugar on top. It's sweet and savoury in the same bite. Made fresh this morning. 8 minutes. A lot of people come back specifically for this one."

04 — DESSERT PITCH WITH TEA PAIRING

"For dessert — the Moroccan tradition is you don't refuse tea. And the chebakia with the honey and sesame makes the second glass of tea mandatory. That's just how it works. The orange salad is lighter if you want something fresh. The seffa is sweet couscous — very traditional, very good."

05 — RETURN VISIT DRIVER

"One thing to know — Friday and Saturday we do Couscous Royale. Lamb, chicken, merguez, seven vegetables, the whole ceremony. We don't do it midweek. Different dish entirely. Worth coming back for."

Menu Overview

Section	Item	Service Time	Food Cost	Notes
Entrée	Harira	5 min	18%	Batch
Entrée	Briouats au Poulet	6 min	20%	—
Entrée	Zaalouk	3 min	14%	Batch, Vegan
Entrée	Moroccan Carrot Salad	3 min	12%	Batch, Vegan
Entrée	Msemen	8 min	16%	—
Entrée	Kefta Cigares	6 min	22%	—
Main	Lamb Tagine	5 min	24%	Signature, Batch
Main	Chicken Tagine	5 min	22%	Batch
Main	Beef Kefta Tagine	15 min	23%	—
Main	Bastilla au Poulet	8 min	24%	Signature
Main	Couscous Royale	—	28%	Fri–Sun only
Main	Chermoula Grilled Prawns	10 min	24%	Shellfish
Main	Mechoui	—	28%	Weekend only
Main	Rfissa	8 min	21%	Batch
Main	Lamb Mrouzia	5 min	26%	Batch
Main	Vegetarian Tagine	5 min	15%	Vegan
Dessert	Chebakia	3 min	14%	—
Dessert	Kaab el Ghazal	2 min	15%	—
Dessert	Orange & Cinnamon Salad	3 min	11%	Vegan, GF
Dessert	Seffa	4 min	17%	—

Daily Prep Schedule

Time	Task	Who	Notes
07:00	Tagine prep — marinate lamb, measure spices, prep vegetables	Head Chef	Start both tagine batches
08:00	Bread dough (msemen), pastry prep (briouats, bastilla warka)	Prep Chef	Kefta cigares formed and chilled
	Batch cooking: harira, zaalouk, carrot salad, couscous		All batch items held at

09:00	broth	Head Chef	75°C+
10:00	Tagines sealed and in oven. Tea station stocked. Desserts prepped.	All	Chebakia batch fried and dipped
11:00	Mechoui in oven (weekends only). Tables set. Staff briefed.	FOH + Chef	Weekend only — 6hr cook
12:00	LUNCH SERVICE	All	Full team on floor
14:00	Second tagine batch started. Msemen cooked to order from 14:30.	Head Chef	Monitor batch stock levels
15:30	Post-lunch clean, restock, mise en place for dinner	All	Check allergen boards
17:00	RESET — full mise en place, team changeover briefing	FOH Manager	Scripts reviewed
18:30	DINNER SERVICE	All	Full team on floor
21:00	Last orders. Begin clean-down of prep areas.	Kitchen	—
22:00	CLOSE — deep clean, stock count, prep list for AM	All	—

P&L Snapshot

Line	Daily	Weekly	Monthly
Revenue	~\$3,680	~\$22,080	~\$95,680
Food Cost (24%)	~\$883	~\$5,299	~\$22,963
Labour (28%)	~\$1,030	~\$6,182	~\$26,790
Overheads (15%)	~\$552	~\$3,312	~\$14,352
NET PROFIT (~33%)	~\$1,215	~\$7,297	~\$31,575

\$95,680

24%

28%

15%

~33%

MONTHLY REVENUEFOOD COSTLABOUROVERHEADSNET MARGIN

Allergen Matrix

ALLERGEN DECLARATIONS — VERIFY WITH SUPPLIER ON EACH DELIVERY	
Item	Allergens
Harira	GlutenMay contain nuts
Briouats au Poulet	GlutenEggsNuts
Bastilla au Poulet	GlutenEggsNutsChicken
Chebakia	GlutenSesameNuts
Kaab el Ghazal	GlutenNuts
Couscous Royale	GlutenMeat

Chermoula Grilled Prawns

Shellfish

⚠ Always ask guests about allergies at order. Cross-contamination risk exists in a shared kitchen environment. When in doubt — escalate to head chef before service.